UNIT 4: STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESS

PART II: OBTAINING AND RETAINING WORK

TOPIC 1: JOB SEARCHING

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Explore a variety of resources available for job seekers
- Increase his or her understanding of different approaches available for finding employment
- Apply their own knowledge, skills, and understanding of their interests and values to finding a job

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Obtain or strengthen knowledge and skills that will help them to search for a job, including understanding and deciphering job postings
- Develop a research sheet of potential jobs to help guide them through the application and decision process

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- Students will explore the variety of methods and resources they can utilize to look for employment.
- Students will understand typical abbreviations used in "Help Wanted" ads.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handouts: **"Top Ten Places to Look for a Job"** and **"Abbreviations Used in Help Wanted Ads"** for everybody in the class, pens/pencils

Hand out to the students **"Top Ten Places to Look for a Job."** Read the handout aloud or ask for volunteers to read the handout. Ask students to flip over to the back of the paper and brainstorm other ways to search for a job — such as the newspaper, specific local job search websites, asking in-person if a business is hiring, etc. Hand out the **"Abbreviations Used in Help Wanted Ads"** and explain this will help them understand common terms that are used when advertising for employees.

Role-Play: Discuss with students the importance of making a good first impression with potential employers when they are job hunting — whether picking up applications, or making an inquiry on the phone, they should be dressed neatly (in-person) and speak professionally. Have students role-play asking for hiring information or a job application on a "phone call" or in-person.

Research/Reflection/Assessment

Objectives:
- Students will search for and select several job postings that are best suited for them (based on what they have learned so far about themselves and jobs — values, interest, skills, practicalities, etc.).
- Students will save three examples of jobs that match their skills and interest in their Student Career Portfolios.
- Students will add a completed "Job Research Sheet" to their Student Career Portfolios.

Time: 30 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Job Research Sheet,"** newspapers, pens/pencils, computers

Ask students to find three "Help Wanted" ads in either a newspaper or online that they think they could apply to either today or upon completion of the program and possibly get hired. (If there are not enough compatible jobs listed, students can generate one of their own (for example — landscape help, or work in a retail store, etc.). Ask each student to think about why (skills, timing, transport, pay, hours, type of work, etc.) these jobs seem like a good match for them.

Have students fill out the **"Job Research Sheet"** including the following information for each job — where job listing was found, location of job, hours and pay, and duties.

Have students save their sheets electronically, and print it for their Student Career Portfolio.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will use the **Mass CIS** system to learn about additional job search techniques.

Time: 10 minutes

Materials: Computers with internet connection, index cards with **Mass CIS** log-in names and passwords

Have students log onto **Mass CIS (www.masscis.org).** Once on the website, instruct students to click on the **"Job Search"** link and explore steps 4 and 5 which provide more information on searching for a job. Students should also begin an **"Occupational Sort"** on **Mass CIS** which will allow them to save occupations of interest for the next class's activity.

Top Ten Places to Look for A Job

Find the Job: If I Need to Know, Where Do I Go?

1. **Personal contacts**
   Tell everyone you know you're job hunting. Tell them what work you can do, ask that they ask their friends and employer if they know of job openings. Include neighbors, family, friends, former employers, teachers, and coaches. Don't forget the receptionist at your mother's doctor's office, your friend's daughter's teacher, or your brother's mother-in-law. Tell everyone.

2. **Bulletin Boards**
   Bulletin Boards at schools, supermarkets and community centers. Most towns have Adult Education/GED preparation centers, community centers such as the YMCA, or technical schools such as ITT. Also, check for bulletin boards at the library, day-care centers, neighborhood businesses, churches and shelters. Special associations, labor unions, employers also post job openings.

3. **Employment agencies**
   There are three types:
   Private agencies: they charge a fee
   State agencies: they're free. There's a huge amount of help at state agencies, everything from job listings to help writing your resume. There's access to computers and the internet. It's all free. Job coaches will often even take your job application and match your qualifications with jobs available statewide. State unemployment offices also have job leads. Additionally, job counselors at state offices can recommend Federal offices or programs that are available to you. Check: there are usually a couple of locations right on the bus route. CONTACT: http://www.ajb.dni.us. This website is run by the (Federal) Department of Labor. IT posts approximately 1 milli on job openings around the country. Also, www.dol.gov where you can order, Job Search Guide.
   Nonprofit agencies: church affiliated (Salvation Army) or community (Goodwill).

4. **Newspaper classified ads**
   Sunday is usually the best day, but these openings go fast, so look every day and call immediately to find out what you have to do to apply. Don't limit yourself to local papers; some papers may have ads for jobs that also apply to your local area. Papers are available free, at the library or employment agencies, for example.

5. **Temp agencies**
   Temporary employment agencies are hired by employers to find workers. The service is free to you. Temporary jobs sometimes lead to permanent jobs.

6. **Local news**
   Read the newspaper's business section. Save ads or articles that interest you. Look for companies that are expanding or moving into your area. Watch for job fair ads.

7. **Volunteer**
   You may gain firsthand knowledge, meet potential employers and help others at the same time. Anthony has a good job as a landscaper. He loves animals and volunteers every Saturday morning at the ASPCA animal shelter. The veterinarian who works there is starting his own practice and has asked Anthony to be one of his full-time assistants. Anthony is flattered and seriously considering accepting the job offer.

8. **Job fairs/Employers**
   Many employers join together at a conference center or auditorium. You can find out information about their companies, fill out a job application and sometimes have a mini job interview.

9. **Community Colleges/Career Planning Centers**
   The Community College placement office is uniquely positioned to help an individual member of the community (that's you) — use his talents to benefit himself and others.

10. **Job Hot Line/Job websites**
    Each hot line and website has its own features. Some specialize in particular occupations, for example, so start your search using a keyword. Posting your resume on a website can be risky business, so call the Better Business Bureau or Consumer Protection Agency to check for complaints against a site before you post.

P.S. Ask other people how they found their jobs.
Look for people who work at a job you think you'd like. Ask them how they got started.

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

Abbreviations Used in Help Wanted Ads

a/c	air conditioning
Am	morning
appt.	appointment
asst.	assistant
avail.	available
ben.	benefits
bus.	business
cert.	certified, certificate
co.	company
const.	construction
dept.	department
elec.	electric
EOE	Equal Opportunity Employer
etc.	and so on
eve.	evening
exp.	experience
exp'd.	experienced
F/T	full-time
gd.	good
grad.	graduate
hosp.	hospital
hr.	hour
immed.	immediate
incl.	including
info.	information
lic.	license
mach.	machine
maint.	maintenance
manuf.	manufacturing
mech.	mechanic, mechanical
M-F	Monday through Friday
mo.	month
msg.	message
nec.	necessary
ofc.	office
pd.	paid
pm	afternoon or evening
pos.	position
pref.	preferred
P/T	part-time
ref.	references
req.	required
sal.	salary
sec.	secretary
temp.	temporary
typ.	typing
w/	with
wk.	week
WP	word processing
yr.	year

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

Job Research Sheet

Name: _____

JOB TITLE and HOW YOU FOUND IT	LOCATION	HOURS AND PAY	DUTIES